

1932



Black swan French designer Chanel did not just create simple jersey gowns. The heightened prettiness of this dress, covering the wearer's body entirely in lace, is toned down by keeping the midriff silhouette simple and using black.



1939

Victorian This embroidered tulle gown was photographed for the high-end Texan department store Neiman Marcus in 1939. Sequins encircle the skirt to create a tiered appearance, evoking the Victorian charm of a Winterhalter painting.

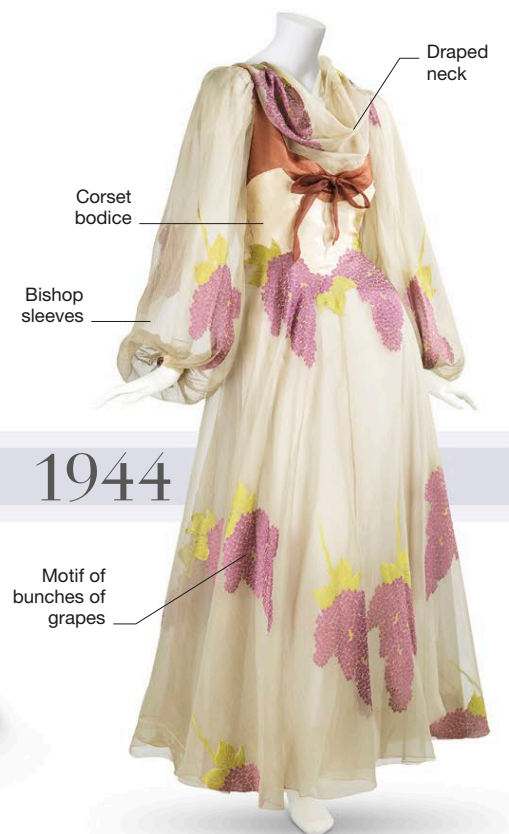


Organza Made from layers of delicately printed silk organza over fine netting, this meticulously crafted evening gown by Madeleine Vionnet has an ethereal beauty. Full sleeves of translucent panels and a gently gathered collar enhance the romantic style.

LETTY LYNTON EFFECT



This outfit was created by Paramount Picture's star designer Travis Banton, and modelled by the actress Liliyan Tashman. The lace jacket with its ruffled sleeves and apron-like front is a clever take on Joan Crawford's Letty Lynton gown, injecting the right dose of romanticism into a sharp, uncompromising white sheath dress.



1944

Contrasting shapes American Charles James created this gown for the socialite and fashion icon Millicent Rogers. The corset-like bodice contrasts with the diaphanous silk draped softly at the neck and gathered at the wrists.